JohnPaul Francois Sleiman, Ph.D.

AGI/AAAS Congressional Science & Engineering Fellow | U.S. House of Representatives
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POLICY INTERESTS

Energy and grid reliability; natural hazards and disaster preparedness; public lands, national parks, and cultural preservation; museums, libraries, and public media; water and natural resources; critical minerals and recycling; federal science agencies (NASA, NOAA, NSF, USGS); STEM education; Tribal issues.

CONGRESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AGI/AAAS Congressional Science & Engineering Fellow September 2026 – Present
U.S. House of Representatives, Representative Paul D. Tonko (NY-20) – Washington, DC
One of only ∼30 Congressional Fellows nationwide from the American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) Science & Technology Policy Fellowship (STPF); sponsored by the American Geosciences Institute (AGI) as the William L. Fisher Congressional Geoscience Fellow.

- **Legislation:** Helped write 2 original bills (1 on cultural resources, Tribal preservation, and national park preservation, and 1 on critical minerals and battery extended producer responsibility); worked on bipartisan appropriations language.
- **Coalition Building:** Advanced priorities for water, natural resources, public lands, and energy at the Legislative Assistant level, building bipartisan relationships with Members, Congressional staffers, state staff, and interest groups. Helped support the Member in his committee and caucus roles, including the Energy and Commerce Committee and its Oversight and Investigations Subcommittee, the Museum Caucus, and the Rare Disease Caucus.
- **Policy Analysis:** Provided expert analysis through dozens of written memos and speeches on environmental, energy, museum, public access, and cultural preservation policy for Congressman Tonko's hearings, events, briefings, and meetings.
- **Oversight:** Helped draft oversight letters and briefing memos and prepared questions for committee hearings; served as a main office point of contact for the National Park Service and conservation and environmental stakeholders.
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Partnered with experts, community advocates, and stakeholders across government and the private sector to research and craft legislative language on natural resources, recycling, and cultural preservation; developed relationships with public- and private-sector constituents to secure federal investment in New York business and industry.
- **Communications:** Wrote one-pagers, section-by-sections, and Dear Colleague letters that explain technical legislation to readers with no science background.

SCIENCE POLICY AND ADVOCACY EXPERIENCE

Local Science Partner, American Geophysical Union January 2025 – September 2026

- **Congressional Outreach:** Conducted direct outreach to offices in South Carolina and New York, organized district meetings and town halls, and helped secure signatures on Dear Colleague letters supporting federal science funding.
- **Appropriations Support:** Prepared request forms for NASA, NOAA, NSF, USGS, DOE, and NIEHS, along with one-pagers and state-level fact sheets used in congressional meetings.
- **Local Government:** Partnered with Rochester, NY, city officials on a citywide urban forestry initiative supported by US Forest Service funding.

Science Policy Opinion Writer, University of Rochester Campus Times August 2025 – August 2026

- **Opinion Writing:** Wrote 15 op-eds on federal science funding, energy policy, natural hazards, and space exploration for a university-wide audience; portfolio available online and by request.
- **Memo Writing:** Authored a policy memo on renewing support for NASA's Regional Planetary Image Facility network, published in the *Journal of Science Policy & Governance* (doi.org/10.38126/JSPG280105).

Science Advisor, Save Paris Mountain, Greenville, SC January 2025 – September 2026

- **Conservation Advocacy:** Advised a grassroots campaign to protect Paris Mountain's forests and watersheds from large-scale development, contributing watershed and slope impact analysis for public advocacy and local government engagement.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION AND EDUCATION

Solar System Ambassador, NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory — December 2019 – Present

- Deliver public talks translating NASA research for audiences in schools, parks, libraries, and colleges across South Carolina and upstate New York.

Speech and Debate Coach — August 2017 – Present

- Founded and coach competitive programs in under-resourced high schools in South Carolina and New York, training students in Congressional and World Schools Debate and leading multiple teams to qualify for national tournaments.

Planetarium Educator, Roper Mountain Science Center, Greenville, SC — August 2017 – May 2021

- Developed educator guides aligning planetarium shows with South Carolina K–12 science standards.

RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher in Geophysics, University of Rochester — August 2021 – May 2026

- **Natural Hazards:** Studied slow-moving soil and landslide hazards on Earth and Mars; collaborated with Norway's national ground-motion monitoring program.
- **Large-Scale Data Analysis:** Built automated pipelines analyzing terrain and satellite imagery across 30+ field sites and 3,000+ mapped landforms, linking hazard patterns to temperature and precipitation with machine learning.

Data Analysis Intern, NASA GLOBE Program — January 2025 – June 2025

- **Citizen Science:** Processed 4+ million soil and temperature measurements and advised educators on sustaining long-term data quality.

Climate Modeling and Software Intern, StormImpact — January 2022 – August 2022

- **Outage Prediction:** Helped build a cloud-based machine learning tool that predicts storm-driven power outages for utility companies and guides emergency crew deployment.

LEADERSHIP AND OTHER EXPERIENCE

President, AS&E Graduate Student Association, University of Rochester — June 2024 – June 2025

Owner and Manager, Cork and Tap, Greenville, SC — August 2019 – October 2021

- **Small Business:** Founded and operated a bar, overseeing daily operations, staffing, licensing and compliance, vendor relations, and marketing.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND HONORS

- Sleiman, J. P. (2026). Securing NASA's Planetary Data Legacy: The Case for Renewed RPIF Network Support. *Journal of Science Policy & Governance*, 28(1).
- Sleiman, J. P., Johnsson, A., Wray, J., Conway, S., & Glade, R. C. (2025). Viewing lobate patterns on Mars and Earth as climate-modulated fluid-like instabilities. *Icarus*.
- Glade, R. C., Sleiman, J. P., Quillen, A., Cunez, F. D., Williams, S. (2026). Exploring potential mechanisms for the initiation of solifluction patterns. *AGU Advances*.
- **Honors:** William L. Fisher Congressional Geoscience Fellowship (AGI); NobleReach Scholars Program; Wallace C. Fallaw Outstanding Senior Award (Furman University); Sigma Pi Sigma National Physics Honor Society.

SKILLS

Policy: Memos, one-pagers, section-by-sections, fact sheets, Dear Colleague letters, appropriations request forms, legislative tracking (Congress.gov), public speaking.
Technical: Python, SQL, machine learning, statistical analysis, GIS (ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Google Earth Engine), remote sensing, data visualization.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Geophysics, University of Rochester, May 2026
M.S., Geological Sciences, University of Rochester, December 2023
B.S., Physics and Geology, Furman University, May 2021